

BALAJIGOWDA HS

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balajigowdahs.github.io/Portfolio/

SUMMARY

Analytical and business-oriented professional with a strong instinct for uncovering the "why" behind the numbers. Experienced in transforming ambiguity into clarity through insight-driven storytelling and hypothesis-based problem solving. Experienced in delivering high impact analytics that optimize operations, improve customer outcomes, and influence strategic decisions. Skilled in applying machine learning, statistical methods, and visualization to drive measurable business improvements.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, R, SQL, Stata. **Analytical Skills:** Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Time Series Forecasting, Statistics. **Data Visualization:** MS Power BI, Tableau, Google Analytics, MS Excel, SAS Visualization, Matplotlib, Seaborn. **Certifications:** Google Analytics, Azure Data Scientist Associate.

EDUCATION

THE GEORGE WASHINGTON UNIVERSITY, School of Business **Washington, D.C**
Master of Science, Business Analytics *August 2023 - December 2024*

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

THE GEORGE WASHINGTON UNIVERSITY **Washington, D.C**
Research Assistant *September 2024 - December 2024*

- Cleaned and standardized 50,000+ rows of Compustat and STR data using fuzzy matching and textdistance, improving dataset accuracy and reducing preprocessing time by 30%.
- Integrated time-series and panel data covering 10 years of hotel performance across U.S. states, enabling comprehensive policy impact analysis.
- Built fixed and random effects regression models that explained up to 62% of the variance in occupancy and revenue metrics, offering actionable insights into the effects of state-level wage policies.

FI CONSULTING **Washington, D.C**
Data Scientist *January 2024 - May 2024*

- Led a comprehensive data preprocessing framework to streamline the cleaning and structuring of 16M+ mortgage records from the HMDA dataset, ensuring flawless data quality and regulatory compliance, setting a solid foundation for actionable analysis.
- Devised and fine-tuned high-performing predictive models, including XGBoost and Random Forest, achieving 89.06% prediction accuracy, while delivering key insights into the underlying factors influencing loan approval trends.
- Implemented bias-mitigation strategies through advanced feature selection and hyperparameter tuning, resulting in a 7.4% reduction in demographic disparities and optimizing fairness in loan approval decisions.
- Translated model insights into regulatory briefs and strategic recommendations, helping stakeholders improve decision transparency and align with compliance standards.

FORTUNE SPIRITZ **Bengaluru, India**
Data Analyst *May 2022 - July 2023*

- Implemented Power BI dashboards to analyze regional sales performance, tracking KPIs such as sales growth, revenue, and market share, resulting in a 17% improvement in territory-level sales insights and enabling leadership to adjust strategies that increased quarterly revenue by 12%.
- Streamlined data reporting processes by automating key workflows, cutting manual effort by 19%, and ensuring that vital sales metrics were delivered with speed and precision to support timely, strategic decision-making.
- Partnered with cross-functional teams to identify and act on 5+ new business opportunities, delivering insights that optimized inventory and pricing strategies, contributing to a 12–18% improvement in overall sales performance across key regions.

COGNIZANT **Bengaluru, India**
Data Analyst Intern *November 2021 - April 2022*

- Improved an efficient, SQL-driven automated data retrieval system, enhancing data collection speed by 33% and eliminating manual data entry, resulting in quicker decision-making.
- Designed and deployed interactive Power BI dashboards, providing senior stakeholders with intuitive, data-driven insights that informed strategic decisions, cross-department collaboration, and enhanced overall business performance.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

EARLY DETECTION OF DIABETES: Investigated and evaluated an XGBoost classification model to predict diabetes onset using health data, achieving an accuracy of 78%. Demonstrated potential for better predictions through hyperparameter tuning.

CUSTOMER CHURN PREDICTION: Developed Artificial Neural Network models to predict customer churn in the banking sector, improving retention strategies and boosting quarterly revenue by \$1.2 million. Identified at-risk customers and proposed personalized retention strategies, such as targeted incentives and fee waivers, to enhance loyalty and reduce churn.